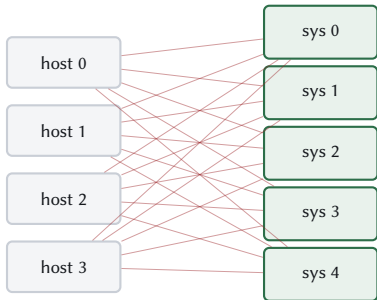


Without a protocol

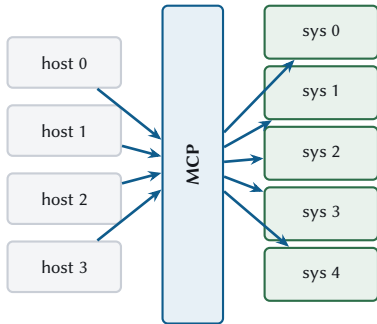
4 hosts $\times$ 5 systems = 20 integrations



*every pair is bespoke code
somebody has to maintain*

With MCP

4 clients + 5 servers = 9 implementations



*one contract in the middle;
each side implements it once*